

I'm So Sick -- Flyleaf

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

2005 (self-titled *Flyleaf*, same album as "Cassie" -- see the guitar patch for that one). ~102 BPM (estimate -- no hard chart reference, tempo isn't load-bearing for the tone choices below). This is Flyleaf's heaviest track, and a very different animal from "Cassie": no clean ambient verse here, the whole song is driven and aggressive, tight palm-muted riffing in the verse building to an even bigger, thicker wall in the chorus, with the genre's usual quiet breakdown mid-song for contrast. The bass job is to reinforce that riff, not sit under it -- present, gritty, mid-forward.

CTL Off = verse (driven, controlled). CTL On = chorus (bigger, thicker wall).

Why a NAM here

Darkglass Alpha Omega (Fuzz) -- the Omega side, Slot 63. Unlike the precise, tight, buzzsaw-industrial Alpha (Distortion) side already used for RammGrind, the Fuzz/Omega side has a thicker, looser, more organic gated-fuzz character -- a better match for Flyleaf's alt-metal/nu-metal-adjacent heaviness than the industrial precision Rammstein's tone wants. Per the current NAM weighting (bass NAMs get strong preference), this beats a built-in AMP/CAB or an IR for this patch.

A NAM can't be footswitched mid-patch (one capture per preset), so the verse-to-chorus dynamic comes from the same mechanism used across this set: a CTL-assigned boost and reverb around a constant NAM voice.

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 40
- Always on. Real distortion at real gain needs a firm gate -- tight palm-muted riffing at this intensity gets ugly between hits without one.

PRE -- Micro Boost (MXR M133 Micro Amp)

- Gain: 60
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Off (verse) keeps the riff driven but controlled. On (chorus) pushes it into the bigger, thicker wall the payoff needs -- a clean lift, not a tone change.

DST -- Off

Not used. The Alpha Omega Fuzz NAM already carries this patch's entire distortion character -- a second GP-5 drive stage on top would just turn it to mush.

AMP / CAB -- Off (NAM in use)

- **NAM: Darkglass Alpha Omega (Fuzz), Slot 63.**

- Settings: Gain 75, VOL 62, Bass 42, Middle 68, Treble 62.
- Gain pushed hard for real aggression. Bass rolled back to 42 -- low end comes from the note and the mix, not amp boom, keeping the tone tight instead of woolly. Middle at 68 for the mid-forward growl that lets the bass reinforce the riff instead of hiding under it. Treble at 62 for buzz/edge on top.
- `AMP` and `CAB` both `model: null` -- a NAM always replaces both.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: -4, 150Hz: -3, 600Hz: +6, 2kHz: +8, 8kHz: +3, VOL: 55
- Always on, both CTL states. Sub and low-mid both cut -- this song's wall of sound has no use for sub weight, it just competes with the kick. 600Hz and 2kHz both pushed for the grinding midrange presence that cuts through a dense alt-metal mix. Not quite as extreme a cut/push as the RammGrind patch -- Flyleaf's tone is heavy but not quite as scooped-and-precise as Rammstein's industrial buzzsaw.

MOD / DLY -- Off

No modulation, no delay. Tight, dry, direct -- a heavy riff like this doesn't want anything blurring its attack.

RVB -- Room

- Mix: 20, Decay: 35, Trail: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Off (verse) stays tight and dry. On (chorus) opens up just enough to add scale to the bigger wall, without turning ambient -- this is still a heavy, present tone even at its biggest, not a wash.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Verse:** Micro Boost and Room both bypassed. Driven and tight, reinforcing the palm-muted riff.
- **CTL On -- Chorus:** Micro Boost and Room both engaged. A real push plus a touch of space for the thicker wall.

Full Pedalboard

Signal chain order: Flamma FS-08 Octave -> Donner Ultimate Comp -> Donner Stylish Fuzz -> Joyo Tidal Wave -> Joyo Narcissus -> Valeton GP-5.

Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed

- All octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +OCT, +2OCT) at 0, Dry at 100
- No octave texture anywhere in this song.

Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged

- COMP: 55, TONE: 55, LEVEL: 55, Mode: TREBLE
- Always on. Squashes pick/finger attack into a consistent, driving level for tight palm-muted riffing. TREBLE mode keeps attack articulate before it hits the already-hot NAM.

Donner Stylish Fuzz -- bypassed

Not used. The Alpha Omega Fuzz NAM already supplies this patch's entire distortion character -- stacking a board fuzz stage on top of an already-fuzz-voiced NAM would just turn the tone to mush.

Joyo Tidal Wave -- engaged

- Drive: 25, Blend: 35, Presence: 55, Level: 58
- Treble: 55, Middle: 60, Bass: 50
- Mid-Frequency toggle: 1000Hz (pick/finger attack and cut-through -- this is a tight, busy alt-metal mix, not a spacious ballad)
- Bass-Shift toggle: 80Hz (tight low end for a dense full-band mix)
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On
- Ground Lift: Off (only flip on if a specific room throws hum)
- Light-moderate glue and a consistent DI feed -- the NAM carries the actual distortion character, this pedal isn't a second full gain stage.

Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed

No modulation anywhere in this patch -- dry and direct by design.

Valeton GP-5

See GP-5 settings above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Verse:** GP-5 CTL off. Comp and Tidal Wave running underneath, unchanged.
- **Chorus:** GP-5 CTL on. Step on it going into the bigger wall, off again coming back down to the next verse.